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Co-education up to Grade 4 in Abu Dhabi schools

ABU DHABI
BY ALI AL HAMMADI
Reporter

All schools in Abu Dhabi will be permitted to operate as co-educational institutions in Cycle 1 (up to Grade 4/Year 5), regardless of school type.

According to the Abu Dhabi Department of Education and Knowledge (Adek), schools must disclose their category (co-educational, mixed, boys-only, or girls-only) on their websites and include this classification in student registration materials.

Schools in Abu Dhabi previously followed a gender-segregated education model. However, with the growth of the international school sector, co-education has become a common practice.

Necessary steps

Schools must also make the necessary adjustments before transitioning to a co-educational setting, such as informing parents and ensuring appropriate building facilities, including sufficient restrooms for both genders, at least one academic year in advance.

Adek clarified that in cases where a school has varying categories across different cycles or grade levels, its approval must be obtained and the classifications must be published on the school's website. Temporarily converting a class to co-educational status is permitted for a single term or academic year under specific conditions.

SEE ALSO P2

G7 summit begins under cloud of escalating Iran-Israel conflict

TEHRAN SEEKS TRUMP'S INTERVENTION TO PRESSURE ISRAEL FOR A CEASEFIRE

CALGARY

US President Donald Trump arrived in Canada on Sunday to attend a summit of G7 leaders, with the escalating conflict between Iran and Israel likely to dominate the agenda.

According to Reuters, Iran has asked Qatar, Saudi Arabia, and Oman to urge Trump to pressure Israel into agreeing to an immediate ceasefire, two Iranian and three regional sources said.

British Prime Minister Keir Starmer said he believed the G7 leaders in Canada were united in wanting de-escalation between Israel and Iran.

"I do think there's a consensus for de-escalation," Starmer told reporters at the summit in the Canadian Rockies.

"Obviously, what we need to do today is to bring that together and to be clear about how it is to be brought about," he said.

"But the risk of the conflict escalating is obvious, I think, and the implications — not just for the region but globally — are really immense, so the focus has to be on de-escalation," he said.

Starmer said he spoke with most G7 leaders after they arrived Sunday and had spoken by telephone to Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu.

Loud blasts

Meanwhile, loud blasts were heard in western Tehran yesterday, an AFP journalist said, as a rapidly escalating air war between Iran and Israel raged for the fourth consecutive day.



US President Donald Trump and Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney hold a bilateral meeting during the G7 leaders' Summit.

AFP

The US ambassador to Israel Mike Huckabee yesterday said an embassy building in Tel Aviv sustained minor damage from a nearby Iranian missile strike, reporting no injuries to US personnel.

A large cloud of black smoke billowed over the area after an Israeli strike hit the building of Iran Broadcasting (IRIB) in Tehran. Iranian state TV resumed broadcasting live after going off air for a few minutes following Israel's attack.

An Iranian missile struck

an oil refinery in Israel's coast city of Haifa on Sunday, killing three people, an Israeli official said after a gag order was lifted.

Israel claimed it had achieved "aerial superiority" over Tehran and has control of skies from western Iran to capital.

Elsewhere, the US ambas-

sador to Israel Mike Huckabee yesterday said an embassy building in Tel Aviv sustained minor damage from a nearby Iranian missile strike, reporting no injuries to US personnel.

Israel's Magen David Adom emergency service said five people were killed and 92 wounded yesterday in Iran's latest missile strikes on the country, raising a previous toll of four deaths. The US State Department warned Americans yesterday not to travel to Israel.

— Agencies

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Overwhelmed and understaffed, the Louvre shuts its doors

Exhausted staff say the institution is crumbling from within

PARIS

The Louvre, the world's most-visited museum and a global symbol of art, beauty and endurance, remained shuttered yesterday — not by war, not by terror, but by its own exhausted staff, who say the institution is crumbling from within.

It was an almost unthinkable sight: the home to works by Leonardo da Vinci and millennia of civilisation's greatest treasures — paralysed by the very people tasked with welcoming the world to its galleries.

And yet, the moment felt bigger than a labour protest. The Louvre has become a bellwether of global overtourism — a gilded palace overwhelmed by its own popularity. As



tourism magnets from Venice to the Acropolis scramble to cap crowds, the world's most iconic museum is reaching a reckoning of its own.

The spontaneous strike erupted during a routine internal meeting, as gallery attendants, ticket agents and security personnel refused to take up their posts in protest over unmanageable crowds, chronic understaffing and what one union called "untenable" working conditions.

Louvre has close its doors to the public during war, during the pandemic, and in a handful of strikes. But seldom has it felt quite like this: tourists lining the plaza, tickets in hand, with no clear explanation for why the museum had, without warning, simply stopped. — AP

SPORT

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